

Assessment Principles Case Analysis

Submitted by Group 1:

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Case Scenario

A university utilizes the blended modality to address logistical challenges among students. A teacher administered a timed online exam during an asynchronous class. Many students emailed the teacher to request that the exam be reopened. Due to an unstable internet connection, these students were not able to finish the exam. However, the teacher noticed that some students were able to finish the exam in a short period of time. Some students complained that others used AI chatbots, while others were disadvantaged due to disruptions in internet connectivity.

1. Introductory statement:

The Philippine education system has increasingly adopted blended learning to improve access to education and address the diverse needs of learners. While this modality offers greater flexibility, it also presents challenges in ensuring equitable access to technology, maintaining academic integrity, and implementing fair assessment practices. Many students continue to experience unstable internet connectivity and varying levels of access to digital resources, while the emergence of artificial intelligence (AI) tools has introduced new concerns regarding academic honesty. The given scenario reflects these realities, as students encountered unequal testing conditions due to internet disruptions, while allegations of AI-assisted cheating raised questions about the fairness, validity, and reliability of the online assessment. This case highlights the importance of designing assessment practices that uphold equity, integrity, and authentic measurement of student learning.

2. Principles involved in the scenario:

- a. Fairness*
- b. Ethical*
- c. Practicality and Efficiency*
- d. Validity*
- e. Authenticity*
- f. Appropriateness of methods*

3. Analyze the assessment practice following these guide questions:

a. What principles are observed?

- i. ***Fairness*** - the students were given equal opportunity to take part in the exam.

- ii. **Practicality and Efficiency** - In consideration of the logistical challenges the students face, having an online exam promotes practicality. While efficiency is observed for the teacher due to ease of scoring.
- iii. **Appropriateness of Methods** - An online examination can be considered a traditional method of assessment. It is one of the effective ways of assessing students' competence and mastery of the subject.

b. What principles are violated?

- i. **Fairness** - The unstable internet connection acted as an irrelevant barrier to test the students' performance and competence.
- ii. **Ethical** - due to the nature of the examination as asynchronous, proctoring proved to be difficult which led to students to use AI Chatbots for their answer.
- iii. **Validity** - Due to some of them not being able to take the exam at all while some of the students who did take the exam utilized AI chatbots. Thus making the exam an invalid way of assessing the students' abilities.
- iv. **Authenticity** - Due to the test being invalid, it fails to meet the mandate to ensure that assessments are valid indications of student competence.
- v. **Appropriateness of Methods** - While the utilization of an online examination is appropriate based on the situation of the students, it demonstrates the limited flexibility of the method. The strict time limit and unstable internet connections served as an obstacle to assessing the student's abilities.

2-3 concrete improvements to the assessment practice:

1. Change the assessment from an online exam into an asynchronous activity. This will allow the students to accomplish the task at their own pace regardless of internet connectivity.
2. Change the assessment method to a formative assessment, ensuring that even though other students use AI they would still learn from the assessment.
3. There could also be a synthesis or a summative assessment when the class is back on site. This ensures that the students who used AI chatbots on their assignments could still be assessed fairly along with their classmates.

Short reflection focusing on your assessment practice as a future teacher:

This case highlighted that a good assessment is not only about measuring what students know but also about making sure that every student has a fair chance to demonstrate their learning. It is a reminder that teachers should think carefully about the assessment methods they use because students have different situations that may affect their performance. As aspiring teachers, the principles of fairness, validity, and appropriateness should be observed, so that assessments are meaningful and responsive to students' needs.